



Replication and Extension

The Development of an Issue Public: Evidence from The Eras Tour

Rossiter, E., & Harden, J. J. (2025). Journal of Politics.

Applied Statistical Analysis II Final Project

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Research Question & Core Theory

How does a private fan experience become politically meaningful?

Issue public

A group with strong, stable preferences on one specific issue, rather than broad political engagement.

Two-stage^{theory}

Stage 1: Potential issue public Fans share identity, interest, and attention.

Stage 2: Activating event A pivotal experience connects that interest to politics.

Why This Case Matters

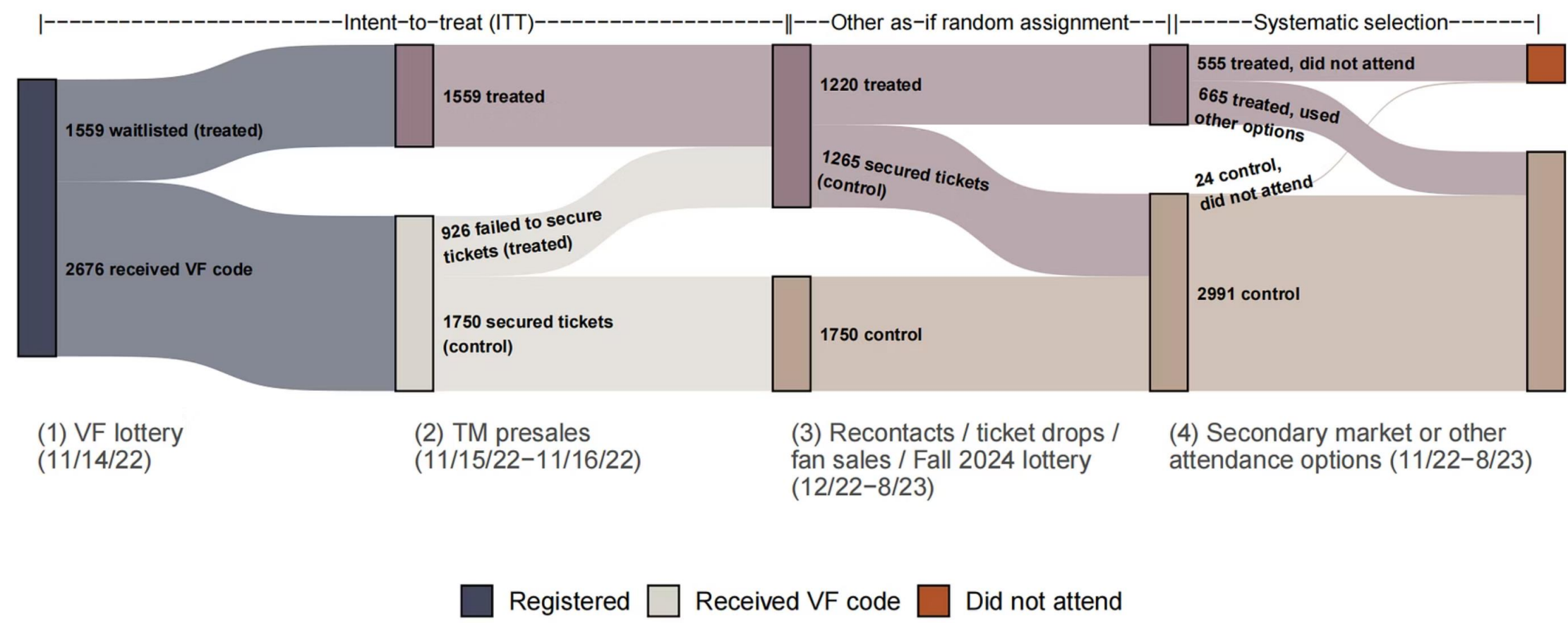
Potential issue public High pre-existing fan interest

Activating event Ticketing controversy

Political activation Issue-specific attitudes and targeted action

Research Design

Figure 4 maps where the strongest quasi-random variation occurs and where later selection begins.



Identification Strategy Early stages provide the strongest as-if random variation.

Why ITT Matters Later attendance is more selective than early assignment.

Exact Replication: Attitude Differences

Table 1: Issue-Specific vs. General Attitudes

Outcome	Estimate (p-value)
Ticketmaster monopoly	0.105 (p = 0.004)
Ticketmaster inequality	0.292 (p < 0.001)
General monopolies	0.044 (p = 0.214)
General inequality	-0.036 (p = 0.214)

What changed Significant increases in Ticketmaster monopoly and Ticketmaster inequality.

What did not change No comparable effect for general monopolies or general inequality.

Key takeaway The treatment shifted issue-specific attitudes, not broad political ideology.

Exact Replication: Behavioral Outcomes

Table 2: Post-Purchase Actions

Outcome	Estimate	p-value
Total post-sale activities	-0.022	0.482
Filed FTC report (early treatment)	0.020	0.043
Filed FTC report (later treatment)	0.098	0.043



What changed FTC reporting increased significantly.



What did not change Total post-sale activities did not show a significant increase.

Key takeaway: Behavioral response was targeted rather than broad.

Exact Replication: Placebo Checks

Table 3: Placebo estimates do not show the same pattern as the main outcomes

Placebo outcome	Estimate	95% CI
China economic expansion	-0.014	[-0.079, 0.050]
Pre-sale political activities	-0.043	[-0.101, 0.015]

Why placebo matters

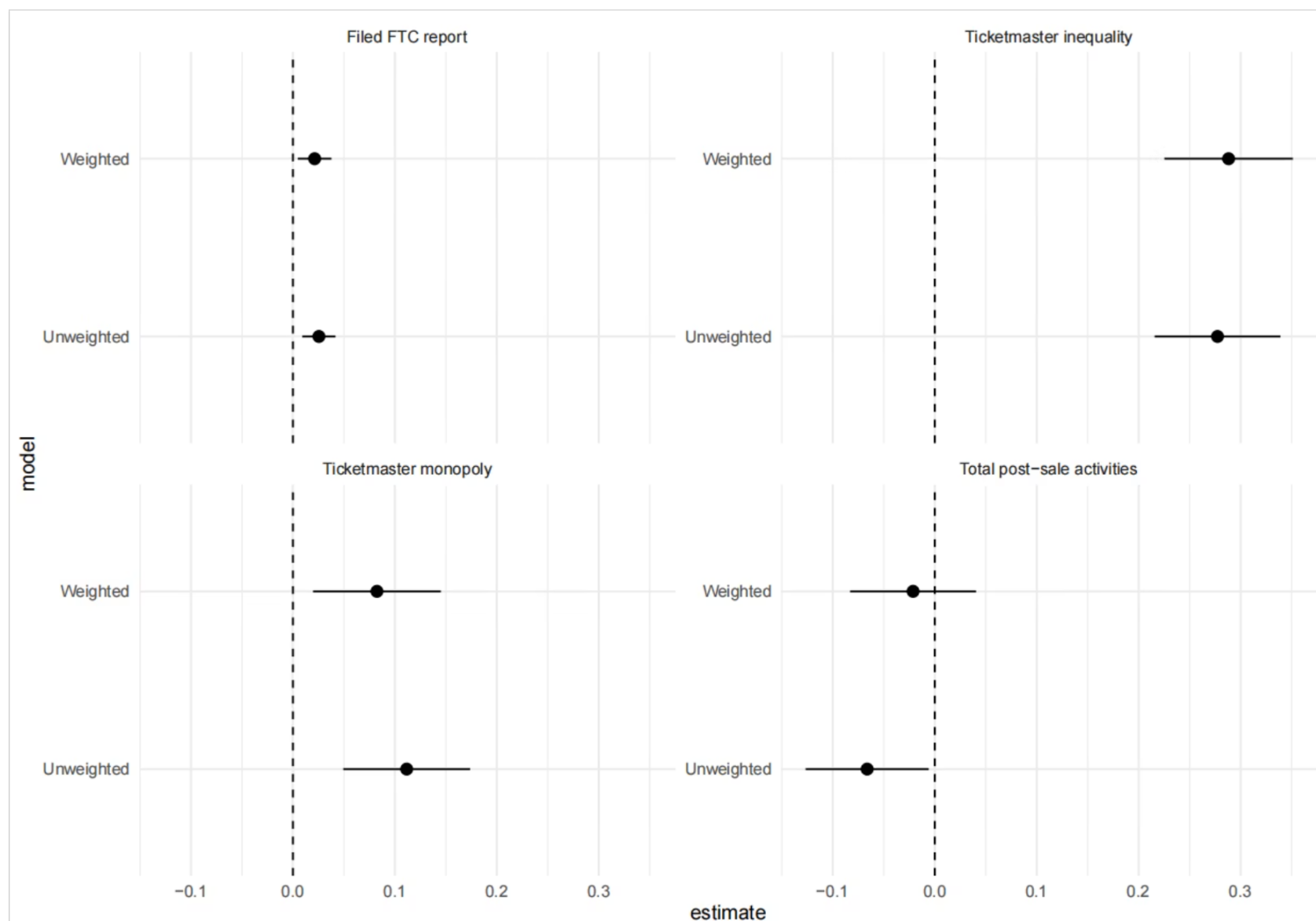
If the treatment had simply made respondents more negative or more politically reactive in general, we would expect similar effects on unrelated outcomes.

Main takeaway

That pattern does not appear here. Both placebo estimates are small and imprecise relative to the Ticketmaster-specific outcomes, which strengthens the interpretation that the treatment effect is focused rather than broad.

Extension: Weighted vs. Unweighted Estimates

Comparing weighted and unweighted estimates across four core outcomes



Why this extension Checks whether the main findings depend heavily on weighting.

What is compared Weighted and unweighted estimates for four outcomes: Ticketmaster monopoly, Ticketmaster inequality, total post-sale activities, and filed FTC report.

Main result The overall substantive pattern remains the same, although some coefficient sizes shift.

Main message: weighting changes effect size more than the substantive story.

Conclusion & Takeaways



Replication Summary Main effects were concentrated on issue-specific attitudes and targeted action, while general attitudes and placebo outcomes did not show the same pattern.



Extension Insight Weighted and unweighted estimates differed somewhat in magnitude, but the main substantive conclusions remained the same.



Final Takeaway A real-world experience of unfairness can activate an issue public, but the activation remains concentrated on issue-specific attitudes and action.

Broader Implication Market failures can trigger focused political mobilization even among individuals without broad prior political engagement.

